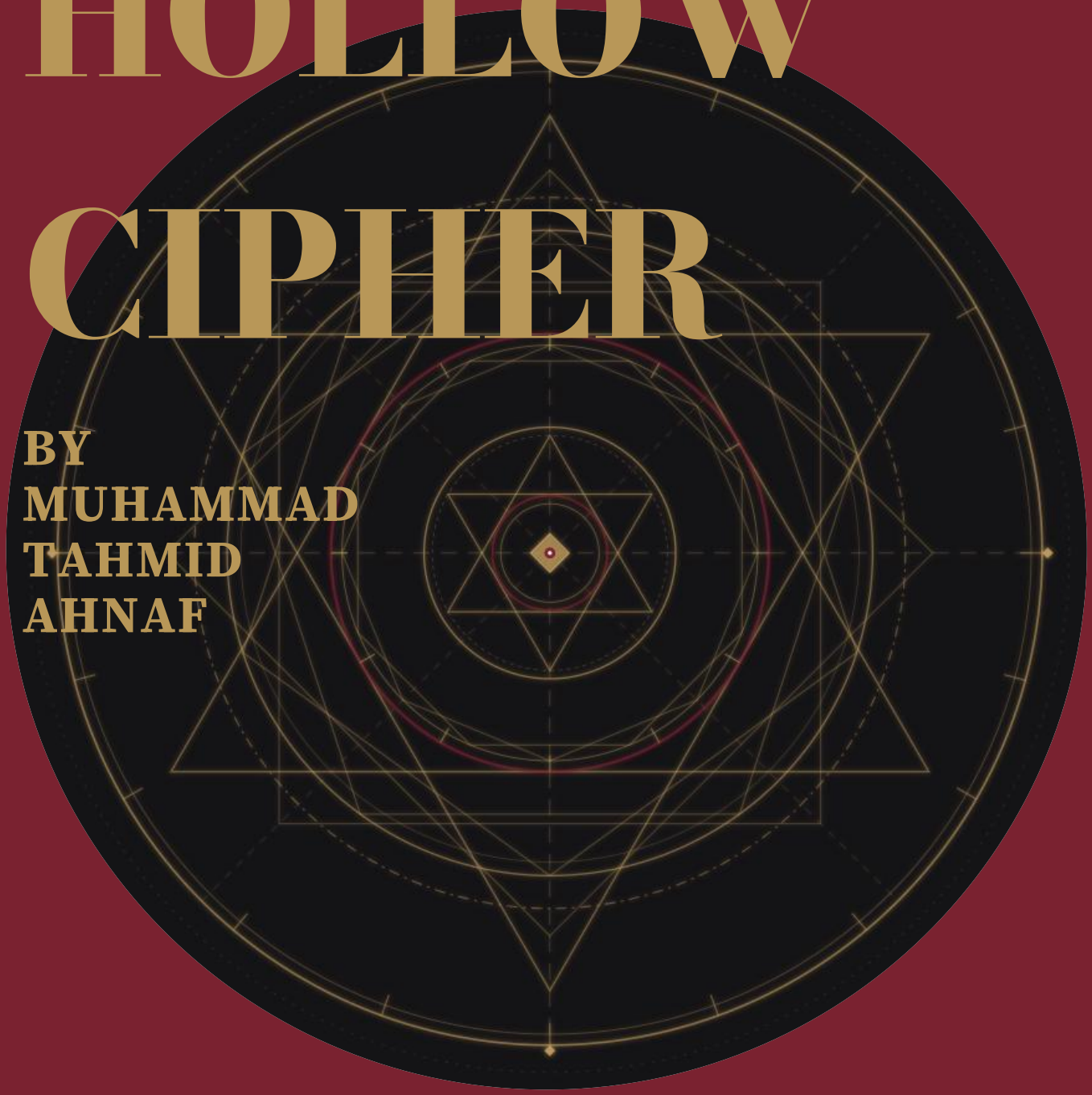
THE HOLLOW CIPHER



BY
MUHAMMAD
TAHMID
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LEVEL 2

THE MISSING NOTEBOOK

[Level 2; Case: The Missing Notebook]

[Time] 14th October, 1887 | 3:17 AM

[Location] Dhaka Central Jail, Dhaka

[Statement]

Nine days had passed since Arif Rahman was murdered.

Nine days since the notebook disappeared from his steel vault.

Nine days since the name Evil Eye's Wrath had begun circulating among men who publicly denied that such a thing existed.

The police had arrested Arindom Kumar Biswas, chief editor of the newspaper where Arif had worked. The case against him was not perfect, but it was sufficient to convince the authorities that the man who had spent eleven years deciding which truths could be printed had finally become afraid of one.

The notebook, however, remained missing.

Arindom had denied possessing it. He had denied knowing what it contained. He had denied involvement in Arif's death until his interrogators stopped asking questions and began repeating his own words back to him.

Then he had asked for a sheet of paper. On it, he wrote a sentence:

"The man who took it has already returned it."

He refused to explain.

At 11:40 PM, Arindom was escorted to his cell. Two guards watched the corridor. A third remained at the far end, beside the iron staircase. The cell was inspected before he entered. Its only window was barred, its door secured from the outside, and its walls were too thick for a man to pass through.

At 2:51 AM, a guard reported hearing a low sound from inside the cell.

Not a cry. Not a struggle. A rhythmic murmur, as though someone were reciting a prayer in a language he had never learned.

The guard approached the door and called Arindom's name. The murmuring stopped.

When the guards opened the cell at 3:17 AM, Arindom Kumar Biswas was dead.

He knelt on the stone floor, his back unnaturally straight, his hands pressed together before his chest. His head was bowed. His bare feet rested parallel to one another, and his body showed none of the disorder expected from a violent struggle.

His eyes had been torn from their sockets. There was blood on his cheeks, but remarkably little on the floor. No weapon was found. The door had remained locked. The corridor guards swore that nobody had entered or left. The window bars were intact. No other prisoner reported seeing anything unusual. Yet the coroner discovered something that made the circumstances considerably worse.

Arindom's fingers were stained with fresh black ink.

Beneath the fingernails of his right hand lay a few fibres of old paper. And carved into the stone directly beneath his knees were seven words:

“YOU HAVE ALREADY FOUND WHAT YOU SEEK.”

The jail authorities called it suicide. The police called it an impossibility. By sunrise, someone had delivered an anonymous letter to the investigator assigned to the case.

It contained a single line:

“Ask Durjo Das what happened to the notebook.”

The handwriting appeared familiar.

It was the investigator's own.

The notebook had not been recovered despite repeated searches of Arif's residence, the newspaper's offices, and Arindom's chambers. The steel vault in which Arif kept it had been opened without visible damage, suggesting that whoever took it either knew how to operate the lock or had obtained access to its key.

During the investigation, the police established that Jawer Chakrovarty had visited the newspaper archive on the evening before Arif's murder. He had requested access to several files connected to Arif's investigation, although he later denied knowing the full extent of Arif's work.

More troublingly, Jawer had asked Mahir Hossain to prepare duplicate photographs of locations associated with Evil Eye's Wrath. Those photographs disappeared shortly before Arif was killed.

The missing photographs and the missing notebook shared a common subject: Arif's investigation. Yet Jawer continued to insist that he knew nothing about the notebook's contents.

Arindom's death had initially strengthened the suspicion that the notebook had been taken to silence him. However, the notebook's continued absence raised another possibility. Perhaps Arindom had never possessed it at all.

If so, the question was no longer whether Arindom had hidden the notebook, but...

Who had removed it before the investigation could reach him?

[Interrogation]

[Durjo Das]

Durjo had been expecting the police. He arrived at the station carrying an umbrella despite the absence of rain. He placed it beside his chair, folded his hands, and asked whether Arindom had confessed.

When told that Arindom was dead, he did not appear surprised. He appeared disappointed.

Investigator: "You knew Arindom was arrested."

Durjo: "Everyone in the newspaper knew."

Investigator: "Did you know he was going to die?"

Durjo: "No."

Investigator: "You answered rather quickly."

Durjo: "Would you prefer that I rehearse?"

Durjo admitted that he had visited Arindom twice since the arrest. He claimed both visits concerned the newspaper's future. When asked whether they had discussed the notebook, he said Arindom had asked him a peculiar question.

"Suppose you found something that proved your entire life had been built on a lie. Would you publish it?"

Durjo claimed he had answered no. He was then asked why.

"Because some truths do not liberate people. They simply tell them whom to hate."

When confronted with the anonymous letter, Durjo studied the handwriting for nearly a minute.

Then he smiled.

"That's clever."

Investigator: "What is?"

Durjo: "Making you think the letter is evidence."

He refused to elaborate.

Before leaving, he requested a copy of the inscription found beneath Arindom's knees.

The request was denied.

As he stood to leave, he said something that was not entered into the official transcript until three days later.

"Don't look for the notebook in a place. Look for it in a memory."

Supplementary interview

Durjo was recalled after investigators discovered that he had removed several newspaper records concerning Arif's investigation. He claimed the records had been destroyed because they contained the names of confidential sources. When asked whether he had taken Arif's notebook, he answered:

"I wish I had."

He then added, almost inaudibly:

"At least then I would know what I was guilty of."

[Jawer Chakrovarty]

Jawer arrived before his summons was delivered. He told the police that Arindom's death had been inevitable. He said it without satisfaction, fear, or grief—as though discussing the collapse of a building whose foundations had been rotten for years.

He denied possessing the notebook.

He denied visiting the jail.

He denied knowing how Arindom could have died inside a locked cell.

When asked whether he believed the death was supernatural, he laughed.

"Supernatural is what men call a crime when they cannot afford to accuse the criminal."

Investigator: "You believe someone murdered him, then."

Jawer: "I believe Arindom was afraid of something."

Investigator: "Of whom?"

Jawer looked directly at the investigator.

"You tell me."

He was shown a transcript of Arindom's final interrogation. Jawer read it carefully, then pointed to the sentence about the man who had taken the notebook and returned it.

"That is not a confession."

"What is it?"

"A warning."

"To whom?"

Jawer placed the transcript on the table.

"That depends on who has read it."

He was asked about Evil Eye's Wrath. His expression changed only once: when the investigator mentioned the possibility that the group had infiltrated the newspaper.

Jawer leaned forward.

"Do not imagine that a secret organization must have secret rooms, secret handshakes, and men in masks. Sometimes it is simply a collection of people who agree that certain things must never become known."

He refused to identify any members.

When questioned about his visit to the newspaper archive, Jawer initially claimed that he had gone there to retrieve routine reporting material. However, the archive register confirmed that he had requested files concerning the same locations Arif had investigated.

Mahir Hossain subsequently stated that Jawer had asked him to prepare duplicate photographs and instructed him not to enter the request in the ordinary catalogue. Jawer denied giving this instruction, but Mahir identified him without hesitation.

When confronted with the discrepancy, Jawer changed his explanation. He admitted requesting the photographs but claimed he had done so at Arif's request. Arif was already dead when the request was recorded. Asked whether he had taken Arif's notebook, Jawer replied:

"I never took anything from Arif's house."

The investigator pointed out that the question concerned the notebook, not the house.

Jawer remained silent for several seconds before answering:

"Then you should ask whoever opened the vault."

He refused to explain anything. His statement was recorded as a significant inconsistency in the investigation.

Before the interview ended, he asked the investigator whether they had been sleeping properly.

The question was dismissed as irrelevant.

Jawer repeated it.

"Because if you have begun dreaming about the notebook, you should tell me."

Investigator: "Why?"

"Because dreams are where people go when they can no longer trust their own memories."

[Mahir Hossain]

Mahir had photographed the original crime scene after Arif's murder. His photographs had since disappeared from the newspaper archive. He claimed that Jawer had asked him to make duplicate prints of several images.

The images showed dead animals, mutilated bodies, and a series of locations connected to Arif's investigation.

Mahir could not remember whether he had made the duplicates. He could remember, however, that one photograph had contained something that did not belong.

A man standing behind Arif.

The man was not present when the photograph was taken—or at least, Mahir could not recall seeing him.

When the photograph was developed, the figure stood near a doorway. His face was obscured by darkness. His right hand rested against the doorframe. Mahir insisted that the figure's eyes had been visible.

"They were looking at the camera."

Investigator: "You said his face was obscured."

Mahir: "The face was. Not the eyes."

The photograph disappeared two days later.

Mahir suspected Durjo because Durjo had access to the archive. Yet he admitted that Jawer had also visited the darkroom that evening.

When shown a sketch of the inscription found in Arindom's cell, Mahir became visibly distressed. He said he had seen the same words before.

Not on paper.

Not on a wall.

In a photograph that had been destroyed.

[Nayeem Ahmed]

Nayeem insisted that the notebook had never entered the newspaper archive. He was responsible for cataloguing Arif's documents and could identify almost every report Arif had requested during the preceding six months. He claimed the journalist had been searching for records dating back to the early years of British administration in Dhaka. Some concerned unexplained deaths. Others described missing persons whose bodies had never been recovered.

A particular series of documents had been removed from the archive shortly before Arif's murder.

Nayeem blamed Durjo. Durjo had requested the documents under a false reference number, then denied ever receiving them. When asked whether Jawer had access to the same material, Nayeem hesitated.

"Jawer did not need to borrow records."

"Why not?"

"He already knew where they were."

Nayeem later produced a catalogue entry written in his own handwriting. It listed a notebook under a title he did not recognize:

THE HOLLOW REGISTER — AUTHOR UNKNOWN.

The entry was dated three days before Arif's death. Nayeem swore that he had never written it.

The ink, however, was consistent with the ink used in the archive that week.

[Shafiq Rahman]

Shafiq had warned Arif to abandon his investigation. He had also warned Durjo, though he denied ever meeting Jawer. When informed of Arindom's death, Shafiq asked whether the eyes had been removed. The investigator had not yet mentioned that detail.

Shafiq immediately claimed he had read it in the newspapers.

No newspaper had published it.

He was asked about the notebook.

"Arif should have burned it."

"Why?"

"Because it was never a record of what happened."

"What was it, then?"

Shafiq looked at the door.

"A record of what would happen next."

He refused to explain further.

Before the interview ended, he requested that the investigator write down the current date and time.

When the investigator did so, Shafiq examined the paper and whispered:

"Good. You still know which day it is."

He was arrested for withholding information. Within hours, his cellmate reported that Shafiq had spent the night speaking to an empty corner. He had been asking someone to return his face.

[Kamal Uddin]

Kamal was questioned because he had worked near the jail on the night Arindom died.

He denied entering the prison block.

He denied seeing anyone approach the cell.

He admitted, however, that he had heard footsteps on the iron staircase shortly before 3 AM.

The footsteps descended. They never reached the ground.

When asked what that meant, Kamal said that he had heard the sound of someone walking down the staircase, yet no person had appeared at its foot. He initially believed it to be a prisoner attempting to escape.

Later, he wondered whether it had been a guard.

Now he was not certain that the footsteps had belonged to a living person. Kamal was shown the seven-word inscription.

He refused to read it aloud.

Instead, he turned the paper face down and said:

"That is not a message."

"What is it?"

"A door."

The investigator raised his eyebrows at the statement. *A door?*

He was dismissed from the investigation after his testimony became increasingly inconsistent. Two days later, he submitted a written statement claiming that he had never worked at the jail.

The signature at the bottom was his.

The handwriting was not.

[Evidences]

[The Prayer Position]

Arindom's body was found kneeling, his hands clasped before his chest. His spine was unusually straight, and his head was inclined at an angle inconsistent with the natural collapse of a dying man.

The initial report described the posture as an attempt at prayer.

The coroner disagreed.

The position required either deliberate arrangement or an unusual degree of muscular control at the moment of death. There were no restraints on the body. No marks on the wrists suggested that Arindom had been bound. His knees showed bruising consistent with prolonged pressure against the stone.

Investigation note: The posture was probably deliberate. Whether Arindom arranged himself, another person arranged him, or something else influenced his body remains unresolved.

[The Missing Eyes]

Both of Arindom's eyes had been removed. The surrounding injuries were severe, but there was remarkably little blood on the floor.

No instrument capable of causing the injuries was recovered.

The coroner found no evidence that the eyes had been removed after death. The injuries appeared to have occurred while Arindom was still alive, although the precise sequence could not be established. A further detail was recorded in the medical report: the muscles around his eyes had contracted in a way that suggested extreme distress.

One guard claimed Arindom had been looking directly at him through the cell door shortly before the body was discovered.

The guard later withdrew the statement. He insisted that he had never seen Arindom's face that night.

Investigation note: The missing eyes may connect Arindom's death to the mutilations investigated by Arif. The connection is suggestive, not conclusive.

[The Seven-Word Inscription]

The inscription beneath Arindom's knees reads:

“YOU HAVE ALREADY FOUND WHAT YOU SEEK.”

The carving appears fresh. However, no stone fragments or carving tool were recovered from the cell.

The words contain no obvious cipher. Their letter forms are consistent with common English handwriting, although the spacing is unusual. A specialist comparing the inscription with Arif's recovered papers identified similarities in the shape of the letter Y and the final stroke of the letter K.

A second specialist identified similarities with the investigator's handwriting.

Neither conclusion could be verified independently.

Investigation note: The inscription appears designed to implicate someone familiar with the case. It may also be designed to make the investigator suspect their own involvement.

[The Archive Register]

The newspaper's archive register confirms that Jawer Chakrovarty accessed files connected to Arif's investigation on the evening before the murder. The requested files concerned locations later identified in the missing notebook's surviving references.

Mahir Hossain independently confirmed that Jawer requested duplicate photographs relating to those locations. The photographs subsequently disappeared from the archive.

When questioned, Jawer first denied requesting the photographs, then admitted doing so but claimed Arif had instructed him to prepare them. The date of the request contradicts this explanation, as Arif was already dead.

Jawer's knowledge of the vault's condition, his concealed access to related records, and his contradictory statements establish that he deliberately withheld information about the notebook's disappearance.

[The Black Ink]

Black ink was recovered from beneath Arindom's fingernails. The substance was consistent with ink used in the newspaper's archive. The ink contained traces of a mineral pigment that was not commonly used in ordinary correspondence.

Nayeem identified the ink as belonging to a restricted collection of archival materials.

He could not explain how Arindom obtained it.

The ink was still slightly wet when the body was discovered.

No pen was found in the cell.

[The Paper Fibres]

Several fibres were found beneath Arindom's fingernails. Their composition matched the paper used in Arif's notebook. The fibres were too small to identify a particular page.

One fibre contained a faint impression of a handwritten letter. Under magnification, it resembled the upper curve of a capital D.

The coroner's report described the finding as insignificant.

The investigator's copy of the report contained a handwritten annotation beside the finding:

Durjo.

No officer admitted writing it.

[The Anonymous Witness]

(Identity Withheld)

Three days after Arindom's death, a letter arrived at the investigator's residence.

It contained a detailed description of the cell, including the position of Arindom's hands, the direction of his bowed head, and the exact location of the inscription.

The writer claimed to have witnessed the death. According to the letter, Arindom had not been alone. Someone had stood directly behind him. The guards had not seen the figure because they had been looking at the door. The figure had not touched Arindom.

It had merely whispered something into his ear.

The letter ended:

“He removed his own eyes because he could no longer bear to see what he had remembered.”

But the man who whispered to him did not have a face.

There was no signature. The paper had been torn from the same type of notebook Arif used.

The investigator's final note on the document reads:

“Either the witness is lying, or the witness is not human.”

[The Locked Cell]

The cell door had been secured from the outside. The lock showed no signs of tampering, and the key remained in the possession of the guard responsible for the block. The window bars were intact. The walls showed no concealed opening. No passage or ventilation shaft was large enough for a person to enter. The floor had been examined for hidden mechanisms. None was found.

Nevertheless, a narrow line of dampness ran from the rear wall to the place where Arindom had knelt.

The water was chemically similar to rainwater collected outside the jail.

The night had been dry.

[The Anonymous Letter]

The letter delivered to the investigator read:

“Ask Durjo Das what happened to the notebook.”

The handwriting resembled the investigator's own.

The paper came from an ordinary stationery supply, but the writing instrument appeared to have been a fountain pen unavailable for purchase in Dhaka at the time.

No fingerprints were recovered. The letter's envelope bore no address, postage, or identifying mark.

A second examination revealed faint pressure impressions beneath the visible sentence. When the sheet was examined under angled light, the impression of another line became partially legible:

“You will believe the next person who tells you he is afraid.”

No one could establish whether the hidden line had been written before or after the visible one.

[The Archive Catalogue]

The catalogue entry for The Hollow Register was genuine. Its handwriting was consistent with Nayeem's, and the ink matched the archive's records. However, the entry appeared in a volume that had been locked in the archive for six months.

The entry was dated three days before Arif's death.

The listed item had no shelf number, no author, and no recorded date of acquisition. A small symbol had been drawn beside the title: a circle with a vertical line through its centre.

Jawer recognized the symbol immediately. He claimed it was a printer's mark.

No other member of the newspaper staff could confirm this.

[The Photograph That Should Not Exist]

Mahir's account described a photograph containing a faceless figure with visible eyes.

The original negative was never recovered.

However, a duplicate print appeared inside an envelope delivered anonymously to the police. It showed Arif standing in a narrow corridor, his back turned to the camera. At the far end stood a second figure. The figure's face was obscured.

Its eyes were not.

The photograph's date could not be verified. The paper was consistent with materials used by Mahir, but the image contained an architectural detail that did not match any location associated with Arif's known investigations. When Mahir examined it, he began to tremble.

He claimed the photograph showed a room he had never visited.

Then he asked the police to burn it.

[The Guard's Testimony]

The guard who first heard the murmuring described a voice reciting words in an unknown language. He later claimed the voice had been speaking Bengali.

In his third statement, he insisted the voice had sounded exactly like his own.

The guard was removed from duty after becoming unable to distinguish between his recorded testimony and his recollection of the night. During a medical examination, he repeatedly asked whether he had already given the same answers.

He had.

Several times.

[The Returned Page]

A single page from Arif's notebook was found beneath a loose floorboard in the newspaper archive. The page contained a list of names. Most were illegible, but three could be read:

Durjo Das

Jawer Chakrovarty

Arindom Kumar Biswas

Beside Durjo's name was a small mark resembling an eye.

Beside Arindom's name was a black circle.

Jawer's name had been crossed out so heavily that the paper had nearly torn.

At the bottom of the page, Arif had written:

The one who is easiest to accuse is rarely the one who needs to hide.

The handwriting was unquestionably Arif's.

The page was dated 12th October, seven days after his death. No explanation for the date was found.

[The Investigator's Notes]

The investigator's casebook contained several entries that they did not remember writing. One read:

Durjo is lying. The paper proves it.

Another read:

Jawer must not be questioned alone.

A third had been written in the margin beside the list of suspects:

Do not trust the person who agrees with you.

The entries were in the investigator's handwriting. The paper showed no signs of alteration or erasure. When asked about the notes, the investigator denied writing them.

The casebook was sealed.

The following morning, the seal was intact. A new sentence had appeared on the last page:

You are doing very well.

The investigator opened a file locked in his drawer.

Jawer has an unusual talent for recognizing the assumptions underlying a question. Rather than answering directly, he frequently reframes the question until the investigator begins defending their own reasoning.

His association with Evil Eye's Wrath remains unconfirmed at the beginning of the case. But now, something unusual has been reported by the spy agents.

He does, indeed, know the mechanisms of the notebook.

He knows how to manipulate people while not loosing his cool. Fariha said he had murdered 3 people the next day Arindom died.

[Past History]

[Arif Rahman]

Arif was an investigative journalist whose final investigation concerned a series of mutilations, disappearances, and unexplained deaths across Dhaka.

He called the phenomenon *Evil Eye's Wrath.*

His investigation gradually led him toward a network of individuals who appeared to share information, suppress records, and manipulate public accounts of certain events.

Arif believed the network was organized. He also suspected that some of its members possessed knowledge that could not be explained by ordinary means. His notebook contained his observations, names, private correspondence, and a collection of symbols he had been unable to interpret.

Before his death, Arif became increasingly secretive. He stopped discussing his findings with his colleagues and began keeping separate copies of his notes.

The notebook disappeared during the murder investigation.

Its contents have never been fully recovered.

[Arindom Kumar Biswas]

Arindom had been chief editor for eleven years. He controlled the newspaper's publication schedule, restricted access to sensitive records, and maintained relationships with officials who could influence which stories reached the public.

He had privately rejected several of Arif's investigations.

After Arif's murder, Arindom was arrested on suspicion of involvement in the killing and the disappearance of the notebook.

His arrest appeared to close the investigation's first major thread.

His death reopened it.

Arindom's final statement suggests that he knew something about the notebook's whereabouts. The inscription in his cell suggests that someone wanted the investigator to believe the notebook had already been found.

Neither conclusion explains how he died.

[Durjo Das]

Durjo was an investigative journalist who worked closely with Arif. Their professional relationship was marked by rivalry, resentment, and a shared interest in stories that others considered dangerous.

Durjo knew about the notebook. He had access to the newspaper archive and had been present during the original investigation. He had also concealed information from the police. His actions make him a credible suspect in the disappearance of the notebook, but no reliable account places him inside Arindom's cell on the night of the death.

Durjo's greatest weakness is not his guilt.

It is that he understands how guilty he looks.

And he knows the investigator understands it too.

[Jawer Chakrovarty]

Jawer was Arif's former field partner and a senior reporter at the newspaper.

He had accompanied Arif to several locations associated with Evil Eye's Wrath. He was familiar with the people Arif investigated, the documents he collected, and the private methods he used to verify information.

Jawer was present at Arif's house on the night of the murder. He was also one of the people capable of accessing the newspaper's archives without drawing attention.

He is not known to have a history of mental illness, and no reliable witness has described him behaving irrationally.

That may be precisely what makes him dangerous.

[Mahir Hossain]

Mahir documented several scenes associated with Arif's investigation. His photographs disappeared from the newspaper archive shortly before Arif's death.

He has an excellent visual memory but increasingly doubts his recollections.

He claims that some photographs contain details he cannot remember capturing. He also reports occasional discrepancies between what he sees through the camera lens and what appears in the developed image.

His testimony may reveal important information.

It may also be unreliable.

[Nayeem Ahmed]

Nayeem managed the newspaper's physical archive and knew where its most sensitive documents were stored.

He had helped Arif locate old reports connected to the investigation. He denies creating the catalogue entry for The Hollow Register. His knowledge of the archive makes him an important witness in the notebook's disappearance.

His fear of the records suggests that he knows more than he admits.

[Shafiq Rahman]

Shafiq supplied Arif with information about unexplained deaths and missing persons.

He repeatedly warned Arif to abandon his investigation.

His statement that the notebook was a record of future events remains unverified. Nevertheless, his knowledge of details not yet made public suggests that he may have access to information unavailable to the other suspects.

His subsequent arrest has made him difficult to question.

[Kamal Uddin]

Kamal worked in night security and had access to the electrical systems of several buildings associated with the investigation.

His accounts of the night Arindom died have changed repeatedly.

He now claims to remember events that contradict his earlier testimony.

The contradictions are too extensive to dismiss as ordinary forgetfulness, but they do not establish whether he is lying, traumatized, or experiencing something genuinely abnormal.

[Evil Eye's Wrath]

At the beginning of Level 1, Evil Eye's Wrath remains an unresolved entity.

Arif believed it was responsible for a series of connected incidents. The evidence suggests that at least some of its members had access to confidential records, manipulated witnesses, and deliberately concealed information.

Jawer appears to have a connection to a subgroup within the organization.

The subgroup's precise purpose is not yet known. Its methods seem to involve more than ordinary intimidation: witnesses report altered memories, impossible coincidences, and experiences that appear to violate the physical limits of their surroundings.

The organization does not rely solely on secrecy.

It relies on making the truth impossible to distinguish from a lie.

[Hidden Resolution]

Jawer Chakrovarty stole Arif Rahman's notebook during the original murder and concealed it to prevent the investigation into Evil Eye's Wrath from exposing his involvement.

His archive requests and attempts to obtain duplicate photographs were part of the same effort to control or remove the records connected to Arif's findings. His contradictory statements about the photographs and his undisclosed knowledge of the vault establish that he deliberately concealed his actions.

Durjo Das appeared to be the likely culprit because of his suspicious conduct and his involvement in the newspaper's records. However, no evidence establishes that he stole the notebook. Jawer's actions, by contrast, directly connect him to the materials that disappeared.

Arindom Kumar Biswas was subsequently killed to prevent the investigation from uncovering what he knew. The circumstances of his death point toward the same conspiracy, although the precise method remains unexplained.

Jawer is therefore the culprit responsible for stealing the notebook. His connection to a subgroup of Evil Eye's Wrath explains his motive for suppressing Arif's investigation, while the remaining evidence establishes the broader conspiracy behind the two deaths.